



CLOUDKART

Returns & Exchanges Guide

Shipping & Orders Knowledge Base

Explains return eligibility, the self-service return process, refund timelines, exchanges, damaged or defective item claims, and international return handling for physical merchandise.

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1. Overview

This document covers returns and exchanges for physical merchandise purchased through the CloudKart Store. It is distinct from the Refund Policy, which covers digital purchases and subscriptions; physical-goods refunds always begin with the return process described here.

Quick Answer

Most physical items can be returned within 30 days of delivery if unused and in original packaging. A prepaid return label is provided for domestic orders.

Agents should always verify whether a return request is for a physical item before applying this policy, since customers sometimes conflate physical returns with digital subscription cancellations. A customer saying 'I want to return my subscription' is almost certainly a cancellation or refund request, not a physical return.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer says 'I want to return my order' — no other detail.

Resolution: Ask whether it's a physical item from the CloudKart Store; if so, proceed with this document. If it's a digital subscription, use the Refund Policy.

Scenario: Customer says the return window shows 45 days in their account.

Resolution: Some promotional orders come with extended return windows — honour the window shown in the customer's Order History, which overrides the standard 30 days.

2. Return Eligibility by Item Category

Return eligibility depends on the item's condition and category.

Item Category	Return Window	Condition Required
Apparel and accessories	30 days	Unworn, tags attached
Branded hardware (cables, adapters)	30 days	Unopened or unused, original packaging
Drinkware and office items	30 days	Unused, original packaging
Final sale / clearance items	Not eligible	N/A
Gift items marked as final sale	Not eligible	N/A

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer wants to return a cable they opened but never used.

Resolution: Branded hardware must be unopened or unused — if genuinely unused but opened, use discretion; an opened-but-pristine cable is often resaleable.

Scenario: Customer wants to return a clearance item.

Resolution: Final sale/clearance items are not eligible; explain at the time of purchase they are marked non-returnable, and that this is visible at checkout.

3. How to Start a Return

Initiating a return is self-service for the vast majority of eligible orders.

- 1 Go to Order History, select the order, and click **Start a Return**.
- 2 Select the item(s) being returned and choose a reason from the dropdown.
- 3 Choose between a refund to the original payment method or store credit; store credit is processed faster and includes a 10% bonus.
- 4 Print the prepaid return label provided, or request a QR code for label-free drop-off at supported carrier locations.
- 5 Drop off the package within 14 days of starting the return; the return is automatically cancelled if not shipped within this window.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer says the 'Start a Return' button is missing from their order.

Resolution: Check whether the order is past the 30-day return window or is a final sale item — both suppress the button. If it's a defect or damage case, open a manual return from the agent console.

Scenario: Customer printed the return label but it's damaged and won't scan.

Resolution: Offer the QR code option as an alternative — they can show the QR code at a carrier location and the label is generated there.

4. Refund Timelines for Returns

Refunds for returned items are issued once the warehouse receives and inspects the returned package, not when the customer ships it.

Stage	Typical Duration
Transit back to warehouse	3–7 business days, depending on origin
Warehouse inspection	1–2 business days after receipt
Refund issued to original payment method	1 business day after inspection passes
Funds appear on customer statement	3–10 business days, per customer's bank

Store credit refunds skip the final bank posting step and are available immediately once inspection passes. Customers who are in a hurry for their refund should be offered the store credit option with the 10% bonus explained, since the time saving plus bonus amount is often more attractive than waiting for the bank posting.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer dropped off their return a week ago but hasn't received the refund.

Resolution: Check the return tracking to confirm warehouse receipt. If received more than 3 business days ago with no refund issued, escalate with tag returns-inspection-delay.

Scenario: Customer wants the refund as quickly as possible.

Resolution: Offer store credit — available within 1–2 business days of warehouse receipt plus a 10% bonus, vs. 3–10 additional days for a bank posting.

5. Exchanges

Exchanges (returning one item for a different size or colour of the same product) follow a slightly different flow from a standard refund-based return.

- 1 Customer selects **Exchange** instead of **Refund** during the return flow and picks the desired size or colour.
- 2 If the requested variant is in stock, CloudKart ships the replacement immediately, without waiting for the original item to be received.
- 3 If the requested variant is out of stock, the customer is offered a refund instead, since CloudKart does not place exchange orders on backorder.

Tip

Shipping the replacement immediately means a customer could temporarily have two items. The return label remains valid for 14 days specifically to cover this case.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer wants to exchange a Large hoodie for a Medium.

Resolution: Guide them through the Exchange flow in Order History; if Medium is in stock, the replacement ships before the Large is returned.

Scenario: Customer's requested exchange size is out of stock.

Resolution: Offer a refund; CloudKart doesn't backorder exchange items since the variant availability may not improve in a predictable timeframe.

6. Damaged and Defective Items

Items that arrive damaged or defective are not subject to the standard return window or condition requirements, since the issue is not the customer's fault.

- Customers should report damaged or defective items within 14 days of delivery for fastest resolution, though later reports are still accepted case by case.
- A photo of the damage or defect is required to process the claim without requiring the item to be shipped back first.
- Damaged or defective items are eligible for a free replacement or full refund, customer's choice, with no return shipping cost to the customer.

Important

Damaged-item claims should never be charged a return shipping fee. If a customer reports being charged for return shipping on a damage claim, escalate immediately as a billing correction.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer's branded cable arrived broken in the box.

Resolution: Ask for a photo; once received, ship a replacement immediately at no charge — no need to wait for the broken one to be returned first.

Scenario: Customer reports damage 45 days after delivery.

Resolution: Outside the 14-day ideal window but still evaluated case by case; if the customer can provide a photo showing a clear manufacturing defect, proceed with the standard damaged-item resolution.

7. International Returns

International returns follow the same eligibility rules as domestic returns but differ in label provision and cost responsibility.

Aspect	Domestic	International
Return label	Prepaid, provided automatically	Customer arranges and pays; reimbursed for damage/defect claims only
Customs paperwork	Not applicable	Customer responsible for accurate customs declaration
Processing time	1–2 business days after receipt	2–4 business days due to customs clearance

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer in South Korea wants to return a hoodie.

Resolution: International return — customer arranges and pays for their own return shipping; once warehouse receives it, standard inspection and refund process applies.

Scenario: Customer in France returning a defective item asks about return shipping costs.

Resolution: Damage/defect international returns are reimbursed; ask them to ship and provide the receipt — CloudKart will credit the shipping cost once confirmed.

8. Common Returns Questions

Answers to frequently encountered returns questions.

Q: Can I return a gift without the order confirmation?

A: Yes, using the Gift Returns portal at cloudkart.com/gift-returns with the gift receipt code on the packing slip. Gift returns default to store credit rather than a payment method refund, since the recipient is not the original purchaser.

Q: I returned an item but haven't received my refund.

A: First confirm the return was received using the return tracking number; transit is the most common delay cause. If warehouse confirmed receipt more than 4 business days ago with no refund, escalate with tag `returns-inspection-delay`.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Customer received a gift but the gift code isn't on the packing slip.

Resolution: The gift receipt code should be on the packing slip in the box. If missing, the gift giver can also retrieve it from their order confirmation; direct the customer to ask the gift giver.

Scenario: Customer returned a hoodie 2 weeks ago and tracking confirms delivery, no refund.

Resolution: Confirm warehouse receipt in the returns portal; if the warehouse received it and inspection hasn't completed in 4+ business days, escalate immediately.

9. Quick Reference: Returns Decision Tree

This quick reference covers the returns decision tree and common exceptions agents encounter when processing return requests.

Returns Decision Tree

- 1 Is the item physical merchandise from the CloudKart Store? (If no → Refund Policy, not this document.)
- 2 Is the item in an eligible category? (Final sale → not eligible.)
- 3 Is the request within 30 days of delivery?
- 4 Is the item in the required condition (unused / tags attached / original packaging)?
- 5 If all above: process standard return. If condition/window fails: check if it's a damage or defect claim (Section 6) which bypasses both.

Return Type	Prepaid Label?	Replacement Before Receipt?	Refund or Credit?
Standard return	Yes (domestic)	No	Customer's choice
Exchange	Yes (domestic)	Yes, if in stock	N/A — replacement ships
Damaged/defective item	Yes	Yes	Customer's choice
International return	No (customer pays)	No	Customer's choice
Gift return	Yes (domestic)	No	Store credit only

Appendix A: Return Reason Codes

Standard return reason codes selectable in the self-service return flow.

Code	Reason
R-01	Wrong size or fit
R-02	Changed my mind
R-03	Item not as described
R-04	Arrived damaged
R-05	Arrived defective
R-06	Wrong item received